Children and Household Burden: The Influence of Pre-Birth Couple Norms

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Abstract

The arrival of a first child is a significant shock to a couple's household labor arrangement. How does this shock affect couples differently depending on their pre-birth division of housework, and what are the implications for individuals' well-being? Using rich longitudinal data from the Household, Income and Labour Dynamics in Australia Survey, I categorize childless couples based on their division of housework before having children and estimate their differential responses to the arrival of their first child. I find a pattern of a larger increase in household work for women who did a smaller share before the birth. On average, regardless of pre-birth division of household labor, couples converge toward an arrangement where the female partner does the majority of the household labor after the first birth. Women from egalitarian couples experience the biggest increase in happiness post-birth, but the biggest decline in relationship satisfaction.

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1 Introduction

Cohabiting couples divide housework considering their preferences and other demands on each partner's time. Some couples share the work relatively evenly, while in other couples one person is primarily responsible for housework. However couples decide to make the allocation, the arrival of the first child increases the household labor burden. The literature is clear that this shock falls disproportionately on the female partner (MacDermid et al., 1990; Craig and Mullan, 2011; Garc'ıa-Mainar et al., 2011).

This paper considers how adjustments to a new child are related to how heterosexual couples allocate household labor before the child is brought into the home. Do couples where the woman does more of the housework before the birth respond differently to the birth of their first child than couples where the male partner does an equal or larger share of the household tasks? If different types of couples experience the transition into parenthood differently, does it impact their well-being differently? For example, do their feelings about their time-use, relationship with their partner, or overall happiness around this major life event also vary?

This paper uses longitudinal data from the Household, Income and Labour Dynamics in Australia (HILDA) Survey to estimate how the birth of the first child influences parents' allocation of household tasks and well-being differently between couples with different divisions of household labor. The survey asks a rich set of questions about household structure and dynamics, including time allocation to paid work out of the home as well as unpaid work inside the home and childcare and several questions on well-being and life satisfaction. This data set follows household members from year to year, allowing me to leverage the timing of the first birth to look at changes a couple makes in time allocation and well-being outcomes of new parents. The survey also reports each individual's own responses, which is particularly pertinent to the questions that ask the number of hours of household tasks they do and to questions regarding their well-being.

I estimate the effect of the birth or adoption of a first child on housework allocation, childcare hours, hours of market work and well-being measures including perception of fairness in household work allocation, satisfaction in the relationship with their partner, and happiness, comparing couples where the woman primarily does the housework pre-birth (Woman Primary, WP), couples where the man primarily does the housework pre-birth (Man Primary, MP) and couples that divide housework evenly pre-birth (Equal). I identify couples in the sample, initially without children, who have established each of these divisions of household labor between the partners. The different couple groups are defined based on revealed pre-birth behavior and do not reflect differences in gender attitudes. I then estimate the in-

teraction between the arrival of the first child and baseline division of housework on parents' time-use and well-being.

A priori, the predicted effects are not obvious. It could be the case that childless couples with a division of housework where the woman takes the larger share are less disrupted by a birth than couples in which the partners share household tasks equally or the man does the larger share. Women in Woman Primary couples might better anticipate and prepare for the additional work after the child is born. Women in Equal and Man Primary partnerships, who are accustomed to sharing the burden of the household labor, might find the new, additional burden, that is less evenly shared, to be unexpected. If instead the more egalitarian couples continue to share housework responsibilities relatively equitably after the birth, the transition to parenthood may be smoother for those couples than Woman Primary couples.

I find that the less household work a group did compared to others of their gender before the birth, the larger the adjustment they had to make. For example, time spent doing housework increased most for women in Man Primary couples and the least for Woman Primary women. Conversely, men in Woman Primary couples added the most hours of housework after the birth and Man Primary men added the least. The changes in the way individuals feel about doing more than their "fair share" of the housework track closely with the change in the time they spend on those tasks. The largest changes are for people in Man Primary couples, where women feel that they increase their share of housework the most and men decrease the perception of their contribution. Women in Equal couples increase their happiness by the largest margin after the birth, but decrease their relationship satisfaction by the largest margin. Despite the significant differences in adjustments for women in Woman Primary and Man Primary couples, I find little significant difference in the changes in their relationship satisfaction and happiness.

There is a large literature on household labor and how couples allocate unpaid work between them, including papers that evaluate the changes in the allocation of household labor, and perceived fairness of that division, around the birth of a child. Previous papers show that intrahousehold bargaining power, measured by relative or absolute earnings of each partner (Dunatchik, 2023; Kühhirt, 2012) and gender attitudes (Baxter et al., 2008; Schober, 2013; Sanchez and Thomson, 1997; Deutsch et al., 1993) interact with the birth of a child to impact the division of household labor. I take into consideration the results from these earlier papers by showing that gender attitudes are similar across couples in my sample and controlling for income and earning potential in my regression, and then look further into the pre-birth characteristics of the couple and consider how their observed patterns of household labor allocation also impact their time-use after the birth.

I use a novel approach to classifying couples by pre-birth household labor allocation. To

my knowledge, this paper is the first to use observed practice in household task division, measured prior to the birth of the first child. This is a meaningful difference because it uses revealed behavior about how the couple operates before the transition into parenthood.

Hornung and Comolli (2025) also estimate changes for couples after the birth of a child, but focus on new parents' feelings about the adjustment in time-use. They estimate how parenthood affects men's and women's changes in perception of fairness of the division of household labor. I use a similar outcome but also interact the couples' pre-birth division of labor with the birth of the first child to see if certain types of couples have different feelings about the change in hours of household work they experience. In their paper, Hornung and Comolli (2025) do not find that effects are driven by changes in the division of housework; however, I find a strong correlation between the change in hours of housework and feeling that the allocation is less favorable for the person.

Regardless of whether a couple has children, relationship dynamics impact the individuals' satisfaction, both with the relationship and with life in general. There is a large body of work in social sciences that discusses the division of unpaid, household labor between partners and how this impacts each person's satisfaction with the relationship, and more generally, with their emotional well-being and satisfaction with life. The existing literature takes different variations of time allocation of market and household work between partners and evaluates life satisfaction and happiness outcomes (Mencarini and Sironi, 2010; Gash et al., 2012; Berger, 2013; Booth and van Ours, 2013; Álvarez and Miles, 2003; Álvarez and Miles-Touya, 2016). They find that women become less happy when they do all of the housework, especially when they also work full-time outside of the home. These outcomes are important in the context of my paper, as they indicate how well the parents adjust to the new arrangement. My paper contributes to this work by also looking at how relationship satisfaction and happiness change for individuals along with changes in household labor division around the birth of a child.

2 Data and Methodology

2.1 Data

This analysis uses the annual Household, Income and Labour Dynamics in Australia (HILDA) Survey data from 2003 to 2022[1] (Watson and Wooden, 2012). The survey includes a nationally representative panel of about 17,000 individuals in Australia each year. The respondents are asked questions on a range of topics such as household structure, employment and income, education and health. There are two features of this survey that are particularly important to the analysis. First it follows households and household members across waves of the survey, even when members leave a household to create a new one. This allows me to include individual and couple fixed effects in the estimating regressions so that the identification comes from within-couple changes from before to after the birth, rather than comparisons across couples and removes the influence of time-invariant factors about the couple from confounding the results. Second, each member of the household over fifteen years old responds to the survey individually. This is particularly important in this analysis as it ensures that each person reports their own hours and feelings about each question, rather than another household member reporting for them, which is the case in many other time-use surveys, including the American Time Use Survey.

My sample is made up of partnered, cohabiting heterosexual couples who are observed in at least one wave of the data before the woman gives birth or adopts[2] her first child and while the woman is less than 45 years old. Couples exit the sample two years after the arrival of the first child, if they separate, or if the female partner turns 45 years old. The restriction to two years after birth is necessary, as more time in the relationship might be accompanied

[1]When thinking about how parents use their time in the year after the birth of a child, it is important to consider the parental leave policy environment. From 2002 through 2010, federal leave granted women 12 months of unpaid maternity leave that ensured they could return to their jobs after the leave (Baker, 2011). In 2009 unpaid leave was codified to include everyone working in Australia. The Paid Parental Leave Act (PPL) was introduced and enacted in January 2011, which paid the primary caregiver, the mother 99.5% of the time, for 18 weeks of leave at the national minimum wage (Department of the Prime Minister and Cabinet, 2023). In 2013 the policy was expanded to include time off for the mother's co-parent. Beginning in 2023, which is the year following the end of the sample period, families share 20 weeks of paid leave between the parents, with 2 weeks designated for the mother and 2 weeks designated for the co-parent. As of 2023-2024 about 68% of workers have access to employer-provided leave on top of the government-sponsored policy (Workplace Gender Equality Agency, 2025).

The HILDA survey asks respondents how much leave, of any kind, they have taken in the past 12 months. Although the reason for the leave is not explicit, I assume that people who were employed and took leave in the same year that they had a birth, were on parental leave. From the analysis sample and based on the assumptions just described, on average, men took about 7 days of leave and women took just under 60 days of leave.

[2]As adoptions make up a very small proportion of the sample, I will refer to both additions as a birth of a child.

by additional children and changes in satisfaction with the relationship, both of which are correlated with the outcomes. Couples that satisfy the criteria but never have a child are included in the sample. Sample couples appear from two to 20 times across the waves of the survey, depending on their response rate. It is possible that the same individual appears as a part of different partnerships in the sample[3]. Couples who are pregnant with their first child at the time of the baseline interview are also excluded from the sample as they might have already begun to adjust their work allocations in preparation for the baby[4].

I compare the changes due to the arrival of a first child on the time use and well-being of parents in couples with different baseline divisions of household labor. In order to establish the pre-child division of labor, I use the responses to questions about hours spent on various household tasks. The survey asks the respondents "How many hours would you spend on each of the following activities in a typical week?" The activities related to household work are: (1) Household errands, such as shopping, banking, paying bills, and keeping financial records (but not including driving children to school and other activities), (2) Housework, such as preparing meals, washing dishes, cleaning house, washing clothes, ironing and sewing, and (3) Outdoor tasks, including home maintenance (repairs, improvements, painting, etc.), car maintenance or repairs and gardening. It is important to note that this does not include any activities related directly to childcare, as at this time the couples do not have any children of their own.

First, I calculate each individual's total hours of household labor by summing the hours they reported spending on the three activities listed above from the first observation of the couple. Then I find the share of the household labor the female partner does by dividing her total hours of household work by the sum of her total hours and the total hours of the male partner.

$$\text{Share}_f = \frac{\text{Total Hours of Household Work}_f}{\text{Total Hours of Household Work}_f + \text{Total Hours of Household Work}_m} \quad (1)$$

I use this value to classify the couples into three mutually exclusive categories based on who in the couple primarily does the housework. If the female partner's share of the household labor is greater than 60 percent, the couple is considered *Woman Primary (WP)* at baseline. If her share is between 40 and 60 percent, and so the male partner's is also between 40 and 60 percent, the couple is classified as *Equal*. Finally, if she does less than 40

[3]For example, a couple made up of $Female_1$ and $Male_1$ may be observed in the data as a childless couple until they separate. At a later time $Female_1$, who is still childless, might appear in a new couple with $Male_2$.

[4]Pregnant couples are evenly distributed between all of the couple types described in the next section, accounting for about 1.50 to 1.68% of each type. This addresses concern about potential bias from removing them.

percent, the couple is *Man Primary (MP)*.

$$\begin{aligned} \text{Woman Primary}_c\ (\text{WP}_c) = 1, \text{ if Share}_f > 0.6 \\ \text{Equal}_c = 1, \text{ if } 0.4 < \text{Share}_f < 0.6 \\ \text{Man Primary}_c\ (\text{MP}_c) = 1, \text{ if Share}_f < 0.4 \end{aligned}$$

Two additional categorizations are considered. In the first, the WP couples are subdivided based on the woman's labor supply reported in the couple's baseline observation. This definition allows a comparison between WP couples with different demands on their time and potentially different total household contributions. The second alternative categorization allows for the possibility that couples change the way they allocate labor from year to year. In this definition, I restrict the sample to couples that are observed at least twice before having a child.

The outcome variables are measures of both time use and well-being of the partners in the couple. Time use variables include total hours of household work per week, as described previously, and hours of paid employment per week and hours of childcare per week. Hours of paid employment and childcare are from responses to questions about hours spent in a typical week in paid employment and hours spent in a typical week supervising, playing with, driving, coaching, helping, or doing other activities with your own children, respectively. All time use variables are measured at the individual level and summed between partners to find the couple-level values.

Some of the literature (Foster and Stratton, 2019; Frisco and Williams, 2003; Wilkie et al., 1998) suggests that absolute time or share of time spent on household labor is less important than the amount of time spent compared to others. To measure this comparative amount, or "perceived fairness," of allocation of household labor, I use the respondent's answer to "I do more than my fair share of housework." This question has the respondent rate the statement on a scale from 1, if they feel that they do much less than their fair share of the housework, to 5, if they feel that they do much more than their fair share. Well-being outcome variables also include binary variables indicating satisfaction with their relationship with their partner and indicating that they have been "a happy person" over the past four weeks.

2.2 Descriptive Statistics

Table 1 provides baseline characteristics of the three couple types. These are means of the characteristics from the first observation of the couple, when all couples are childless. Couples

are generally not married and have been together for about one and a half years. Marriage rates are low and relationship durations short because this is the first time we observe the couple in the data. While some couples are surveyed initially as an established couple, many times the survey follows one person and then their partner becomes part of the survey due to becoming part of the same household. The couple types have a meaningful difference in average household income. It is not surprising that women in Equal and MP couples have higher labor supply than women in WP couples and that these couples have higher total income.

The first three rows of the gendered panels are expected to vary across couple type. By the definition of the categories, we expect men in WP couples to spend less time doing the various household activities than men in MP couples, and vice versa for the women. Similarly, it is not surprising that men who spend less time on household work, spend more time in paid work. Men in WP and Equal couples have very similar rates of working full time and part time, while men in MP couples are less likely to work full time and have higher rates of not being employed, however their incomes are relatively similar. Age, post-secondary education, Indigenous status, and immigrant status are balanced for men across couple types. While the sample criteria require the women to have no previous children and no children living with the couple, it is possible that the men have a non-resident child from a previous relationship. Fewer than 9% of men in all couple types have a non-resident child.

Employment characteristics vary much more for women in different couple types. Women in WP couples are much less likely to work full time than their counterparts in other couples, and have the highest rates of part time work and unemployment. Accordingly their individual income is the lowest. Women in Equal couples have the highest rate of post-secondary education and income but a slightly lower rate of working full time than women in MP couples. As with men, age and being Indigenous or an immigrant are relatively balanced across couple types.

Table 2 gives average responses by couple type for a series of statements about gender attitudes. This helps to give an idea of whether the couples might be ideologically different at baseline[5]. The respondent is asked the extent to which they agree with each statement on a scale from one to seven, where a one indicates that they strongly disagree with the statement and a seven indicates that they strongly agree with the statement. While the couples are grouped by observed behavior, the response to gender attitude questions gives insight into the couples' preferences. Figure 1 highlights three questions that are particularly pertinent

[5]This set of questions is not included in the survey every year. The responses included in the averages shown are from individuals in the sample who were asked this set of questions in the first wave in which they are observed.

to the research question presented here. To ease visualization the responses are recoded so that a six represents a more progressive view and a zero represents a more conservative view on all questions. On average men tend to be slightly more conservative than women and the individuals in WP couples tend to have slightly more traditional views than people of the same gender in the other two couple types. The differences between couple types for the first two questions in the figure, "It is not better if the man works and the woman takes care of the home and children" and "Kids do just as well if mom works and dad takes care of the home," are minor. The responses to "If both partners work, they should share the housework and childcare equally" are not statistically different between couple types. This suggests that there is not a strong correlation between couple type and gender attitudes and that couples are not sorting into their couple types based primarily on their preferences for who they believe should be doing market work and household work.

Table 3 provides statistics for baseline means of the outcomes. Again, it is expected to see different averages of total hours per week spent on household tasks and paid work for both men and women in each of the baseline couple types by definition. A response to the statement regarding doing their share of the housework, of 3 means that the person feels that they do exactly their fair share. The men in WP and Equal couples, on average, feel that they are doing very close to their fair share and men in MP couples feel that they do marginally more than their fair share. Despite the number of hours or share of time spent, the women in all couple types feel that they do more than their fair share of household work and, on average, more than their partners, even in MP couples. At baseline, less than half of people are satisfied with their relationships. Men and women in MP couples are the least satisfied with their relationships. The baseline variables, with support from the gender attitudes responses, suggest that the MP configuration may not be based on preferences but be a result of practical choices due to financial or employment prospects for many couples.

2.3 Empirical Strategy

I employ a fixed effects model with interaction terms for couple type to estimate the effect of having a child on people in different couples. I estimate the following regression separately by gender:

$$Y_{ict} = \beta_1 \text{Birth}_{ct} * \text{WP}_c + \beta_2 \text{Birth}_{ct} * \text{Equal}_c + \beta_3 \text{Birth}_{ct} * \text{MP}_c + \delta \text{Birth}_{ct} * Z_c + \gamma X_{ict} + \pi_i + \mu_c + \eta_t + \epsilon_{ict} \quad (2)$$

where Y_{ict} is the outcome for an individual i in couple c during wave t. The treatment, $Birth_{ct}$, indicates whether the couple has a child. $Birth_{ct} = 0$ in the waves before the couple

has a child or in all waves if the couple never has a child. $Birth_{ct} = 1$ in the waves after the birth. As couples exit the sample two years after the first birth, a couple will have $Birth_{ct} = 1$ for a maximum of two waves.

Z_c includes baseline values of household income, marital status, and whether each partner has post-secondary education. These variables are interacted with $Birth_{ct}$ to control for the fact that the impact of the first birth likely varies by these characteristics as well. π_i, μ_c and η_t are individual, couple and wave fixed effects, respectively. Individual fixed effects are necessary because individuals can appear in the sample as part of different couples. While the linear effects of age of the individual and duration of the relationship are collinear with the fixed effects, age_{it}^2, a quadratic age control for the individual, and $duration_{ct}^2$, a quadratic relationship duration control, are included in X_{ict}.

The coefficients of interest, β_1, β_2, and β_3, estimate the total change to Y_{ict} after having a child for individuals in WP, Equal, and MP couples, respectively. I report p-values for tests of equality for each pairwise comparison among these three coefficients. Additionally, p-values are reported to compare the effects between men and women [6].

3 Results

3.1 Main Couple Type Analysis

3.1.1 Changes in Time Use

This section presents the empirical results examining the differential impact of having a child on different types of couples, defined by their pre-birth allocation of household labor. Table 4 looks at the changes in hours couples and individuals spend doing unpaid household labor and paid work. The first column presents the results for the couple, combining the change in hours for both partners in the couple. The second and third columns report the results for women and men separately. The last column reports the p-value that tests if the coefficient for women and men within a couple type are statistically the same. The p-values below each couple test the pairwise comparison of the coefficients for each couple type.

Panel i shows that all couple types add about 8.75 to 9.5 hours of housework per week after a birth. This result here indicates that the additional housework that comes with arrival of a child is consistent. However, the way couples allocate that set of hours is not. Women in WP make the smallest adjustment among the women, still adding 6.78 hours, and women

[6] The p-values to compare results for men and women come from the model shown interacted with sex, i.e. $Y_{ict} = \beta_1 \text{Birth}_{ct} * \text{WP}_c + \beta_2 \text{Birth}_{ct} * \text{Equal}_c + \beta_3 \text{Birth}_{ct} * \text{MP}_c + \beta_4 \text{Birth}_{ct} * \text{WP}_c * \text{Female}_i + \beta_5 \text{Birth}_{ct} * \text{Equal}_c * \text{Female}_i + \beta_6 \text{Birth}_{ct} * \text{MP}_c * \text{Female}_i + \delta \text{Birth}_{ct} * \text{Z}_c * \text{Female} + \gamma X_{ict} * \text{Female}_i + \pi_i + \mu_c \text{Female}_i + \eta_t \text{Female}_i + \epsilon_{ict}$

in MP couples make the largest change, adding 8.81 hours, with Equal women only slightly less with an additional 8.39 hours of housework. This represents a 130% increase in hours of household work for MP women and a 35% increase for WP women. WP men make the largest change among the men, adding just over two hours. Men in Equal and MP couples add up to 1.3 hours but this is not statistically different than zero. There is a clear trend that the smaller share the partner did at baseline, the greater number of hours of household labor they will add after the birth, although men and women add on very different scales. Column 4 provides a statistical comparison of the changes in men's and women's hours of household work after a first birth.

In the second panel, the change in hours of paid employment is estimated. As expected, women decrease their work hours by much more than men do. The effect of the birth on MP and Equal couples is nearly identical and point estimates suggest that only the WP couples respond differentially in their work hours. WP women decrease their labor supply hours by 16 hours, about a 54% reduction from their baseline average, while MP and Equal women decrease theirs by almost 18 hours, about a 51.5% reduction. This difference is likely due to the difference in hours of work pre-birth. As MP and Equal women are more likely to work, and work full time, than WP women, they need to take a greater reduction in hours to recover and care for the new child. For all men there is a small increase in hours although none are statistically significant, with the largest change coming from MP men adding almost an hour and a half of work per week.

Table 5 compares the average amount of childcare done by couple type. Couples do between 51.93 and 54.73 hours of childcare, with WP couples doing the most, followed by Equal couples, and finally MP couples, although the differences are not statistically significant. Unlike in hours of household work and market work, where Equal and MP women are similar, in hours of childcare WP and Equal women do similar amounts of childcare at about 47 hours per week, while MP women do 2 hours less on average. Again, unlike previous patterns, WP and MP men do similar amounts of childcare, about 14.25 hours, and Equal men do about one hour more.

For hours of housework, Figure 2 shows the event study from 3 years before a birth to one full year after the birth. The reference period is the wave before the birth, wave -1 relative to the birth, year 0 is the first time we observe the couple with the new child. This implies that the birth occurred sometime between wave -1 and wave 0. Finally, year 1 represents the second wave the couple is observed with the child. Couples are removed from the sample after this point in order to avoid conflating the results with influences from other life events. The event study is done separately for men and women and shows the trends for each couple type. In the women's panel, the WP and Equal women have similar trends pre-birth, while

MP women increase their time spent doing housework in the years prior to the birth. With the birth there is a large increase in hours for all women and a slight decrease in the following year. A much smaller increase for men in the year of the birth is shown and only WP men increase hours of household tasks in the following year.

Figure 3 gives a similar event study for hours of paid employment. Again there is a large drop in hours for women in all couple types, in Equal and MP couples most dramatically, in the year of the birth. This likely accounts for maternity leave as well as a longer-term reduction in hours. In the following year women add back six to eight hours of paid work on average. Before the birth men in Equal and WP couples have similar trends for hours of work with MP men slightly less. After the birth men make no meaningful change in their hours of paid work.

3.1.2 Changes in Well-Being Measures

From the previous results, it is clear that there is a change in the way that couples allocate their time between household work and paid work, in addition to adding childcare. Do these shifts affect the dynamic between the partners and the mental well-being outcomes of individuals? Table 6 explores how people feel about the amount of housework they do. Recall that at baseline, on average, women felt that they were doing a bit more than their fair share of the housework, even in MP couples. After the birth, women in all couple types feel that they are doing even more than their share of the household work. Men either stay the same or feel that they are doing less than before the birth. The results for the perception of work are in alignment with the actual number of hours added. Men and women in WP couples have the smallest changes, 0.089 (2.2 percent of the scale maximum) and 0.271 (6.8 percent of the scale maximum) point increases, respectively, while men and women in MP couples have the largest changes. On average, women in MP couples increase their feeling of doing "more than their share" by 0.515, a 12.9 percent increase on the scale maximum, while men in MP couples decrease by 0.138, a 2.8 percentage point decrease. Again, column 3 confirms that men and women have statistically different changes in perception of housework after the birth for Equal and MP couples.

Relationship satisfaction and happiness are other measures that can be used to gauge how individuals in the couple respond to the shock of having a child. In table 7, men and women in all couple types are less satisfied with their relationship after a birth. Equal women, who add similar hours of housework to MP women and whose partners do more childcare than other men, have the biggest decrease in relationship satisfaction but the largest increase in happiness, 9 percentage points. Even though women in WP and MP couples have the most different experience in their adjustment post-birth, they have similar changes in their

relationship satisfaction. In fact, despite having the lowest levels of relationship satisfaction at baseline, doing 130% more housework than before the birth and feeling that they are doing much more housework than before, MP women decrease their relationship satisfaction the least among the women. The effect of a birth on happiness is negative and insignificant for all men. Men make relatively small changes to their time use and similarly small changes to their well-being. For women, the changes in time use do not correlate consistently with changes in well-being measures, contrary to what previous literature suggests.

3.2 Alternative Definitions

Alternative ways of categorizing the couples provide insight into factors that might also influence household labor allocation pre-birth and adjustment after the birth.

3.2.1 Women's Labor Supply

The first alternative definition of the couples considers both the share of the household labor the female partners do, as well as their labor supply. All couples that are MP or Equal at baseline are grouped into the non-Woman Primary assignment. The WP couples at baseline are divided into those where the woman works full time (WP+FT) and those where she does not work full time (WP+noFT). This definition allows a comparison between WP couples with different demands on their time and potentially different total household contributions. In WP couples where the woman does not work full time, one might assume that the female partner specializes in taking care of the household, while the male partner specializes in paid work. In this case the total work necessary to maintain the household is divided between the partners by each taking ownership of a different domain. In the WP couples where the female partner also works full time, we assume that this scenario puts the largest potential stress on one partner's time, especially after the shock of a child. Selected baseline characteristics are provided in table A.1. The most notable difference between couple types is their household income, which is partly a function of the categories' definitions including labor supply of one partner.

As this classification emphasizes the difference in time demands, the most relevant outcome is to look at changes in how individuals spend their time after the birth of a child as shown in table 8. As expected from previous results, women in nonWP couples add the greatest number of hours of household work post-birth. The difference between the WP women that work full time and those that don't is more surprising. Despite seeming to have greater demands on their time, the WP+FT women add more hours of household labor than WP+noFT women by a difference of about 2.5 hours per week. Per table A.1, at baseline,

women in WP+noFT couples do an average of 4.5 hours more household labor than WP women who work full time. These results continue the trends that the increase in the time women spend on household work after the birth is inversely related to the amount of time they spend on household tasks before the birth, regardless of labor supply. The WP+FT men add fewer hours of housework than the WP+noFT men. While this result may seem counterintuitive, there are two reasons this might be the case. First, the male partners in WP+noFT couples do less paid work than WP+FT men. Second, it might be the case women who already specialized in housework simply cannot add as many additional hours of housework on top of what they did prior to the birth. WP+noFT men also add more hours of childcare than men in WP+FT couples, while the women in both couples do just over 47 hours of childcare per week, as shown in table 9.

The event study for hours of household work with the couple assignment considering labor supply, figure 4, highlights the pre-birth difference between women in WP couples that do not work full time and the other women. Women that specialize in household work spend relatively more time doing housework in the years before the birth, which causes a smaller relative jump in hours after the birth. Similarly, in figure 5, women in WP couples that work full time have relatively more hours of pre-birth paid employment than the other women and a larger reduction in hours in year 0. This figure also shows clearly that WP women who do not work full time make a much smaller adjustment in hours of market work than the other women in the year of the birth and add back fewer hours the following year. Again this is a result of this group working fewer hours at baseline and being less strongly attached to the labor market.

To see how individuals feel about the changes in hours, table 10 gives changes in perceived fairness of the division of household labor. The feeling of doing their "fair share" correlates with the changes in hours of household work, not with the overall amount of household and paid work done. For example, even though WP+FT women do a greater share of household work at baseline than nonWP women by definition, WP+FT women add fewer hours of housework than nonWP women and do not increase their feelings of doing more than their share by as much. The same holds for men; the greater number of hours of housework they add, the greater their feelings of doing more than their share, regardless of the total number of hours of household work they do.

3.2.2 Consistent Couple Type

It is possible that the baseline observation is an unusual year or that the couple is fluid in their assignment of household tasks. In this definition, I restrict the sample to couples that are observed at least twice before having a child. I categorize their couple type for each

of the first two waves that they appear. Then the couples are categorized as (1) couples that are consistently WP, appearing as WP in both waves, (2) couples that have consistent assignment but are not WP, appearing as Equal in both waves or MP in both waves, and (3) couples that are flexible and change couple type between the first two waves they appear.

This classification is important to determine if couples are truly a particular couple type at baseline. Results that are similar to the main analysis would support the original classification method. This would provide evidence that using behavior observed once is enough to identify behavior patterns. Different results suggest that couples change frequently and classifying based on one observation does not effectively capture their true behavior. Then one might wonder if the results presented are from normal fluctuations in the way couples allocate work. Table A.2 provides selected baseline characteristics by this couple type definition. Consistently WP couples are similar to WP couples at baseline and Consistently non-WP couples are similar to the average of Equal and MP couples at baseline.

Table 11 provides very similar results to table 4. The consistently WP and consistently non WP women increase their hours by about the same amount as WP and non-WP from the main definition. Men's results are also in alignment. The same holds for the paid employment changes. These results emphasize that the effects found in previous tables are robust to more restrictive definitions of the couple types.

4 Conclusion

This paper explores how couples with different pre-birth allocation of housework respond differently to the arrival of a first child, both in terms of time use and well-being. Evidence from previous literature establishes that the additional work that comes with a new child is disproportionately distributed to female partners and that partners who do a larger share of household tasks tend to be less happy and less satisfied with their relationships. Whether pre-birth couple norms could protect couples against some of these effects was an open question.

The results confirm the findings of previous studies that women increase their hours of household work more than men after the birth of a child. The trend in how many hours of household tasks an individual adds after the birth is closely associated with their contribution to those activities before the birth – the less they did before the birth, the more was added after, with men and women on different scales. This trend results in a convergence toward a WP allocation after a birth, even for couples that had a very different allocation of labor at baseline. Perceived fairness mirrors actual hours closely, where women across all couple types feel that they do more than their fair share after the birth with the largest effect among

women in MP couples.

Despite meaningful differences between the adjustment in hours of housework WP and MP women make after the birth of the first child, there is very little difference in their relationship satisfaction and happiness. Couples who experience the largest shift in allocation of household tasks, those in MP couples, do not report significantly different well-being outcomes to those that had much smaller changes in allocation, those in WP couples. This finding suggests that no particular division of household labor is better suited to protect the individuals' well-being than any other.

This analysis provides descriptive results about how different types of couples handle the shock of adding a child to their household; however, it also raises more questions. We have seen that despite revealed behavior and preferences, couples move toward an allocation of labor where the female partner does most of the housework. Why does this pattern occur for so many different types of couples? It could be that after the birth of a child, there is so much household labor and paid labor to be done that individuals in the household must specialize, similar to the approach taken in growing firms. The results found here could be due to the asymmetrical leave policies that allow women to be at home after the birth and provide far less leave to men. It could also be due to logistics of the birthing person needing time to physically recover and be accessible to the new child. Further study is necessary to explore these mechanisms.

The results presented here might also help to inform policies regarding parental leave and childcare subsidies. This study might provide support for more equitable co-parent leave so that fathers and partners can be more supportive of the new baby as well as their partner after the birth. It might also highlight the demands on new parents' time, which would benefit from high-quality and cost-effective childcare options.

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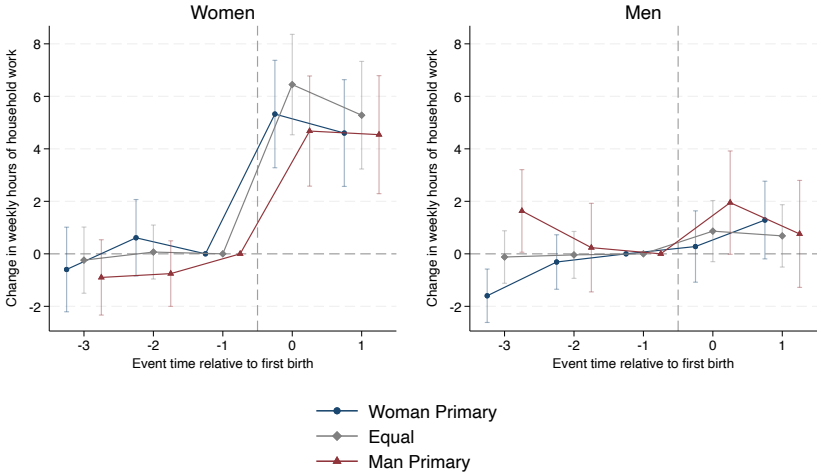
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Figure 1: Selected Gender Attitude Responses, by Couple Type



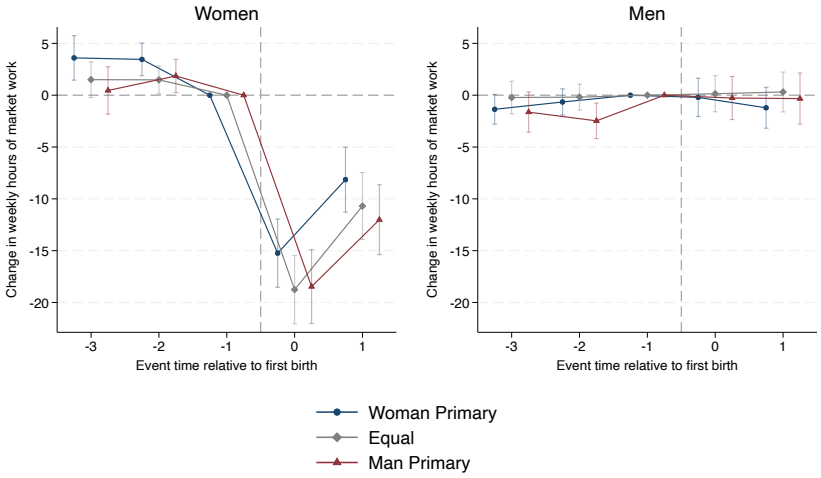
Notes: The figure shows average values for responses to gender attitude questions by gender and couple type. This set of questions is not asked in every wave. The averages in the figure include the responses from individuals asked during their baseline wave.

Figure 2: Hours of Household Work Event Study, by Couple Type



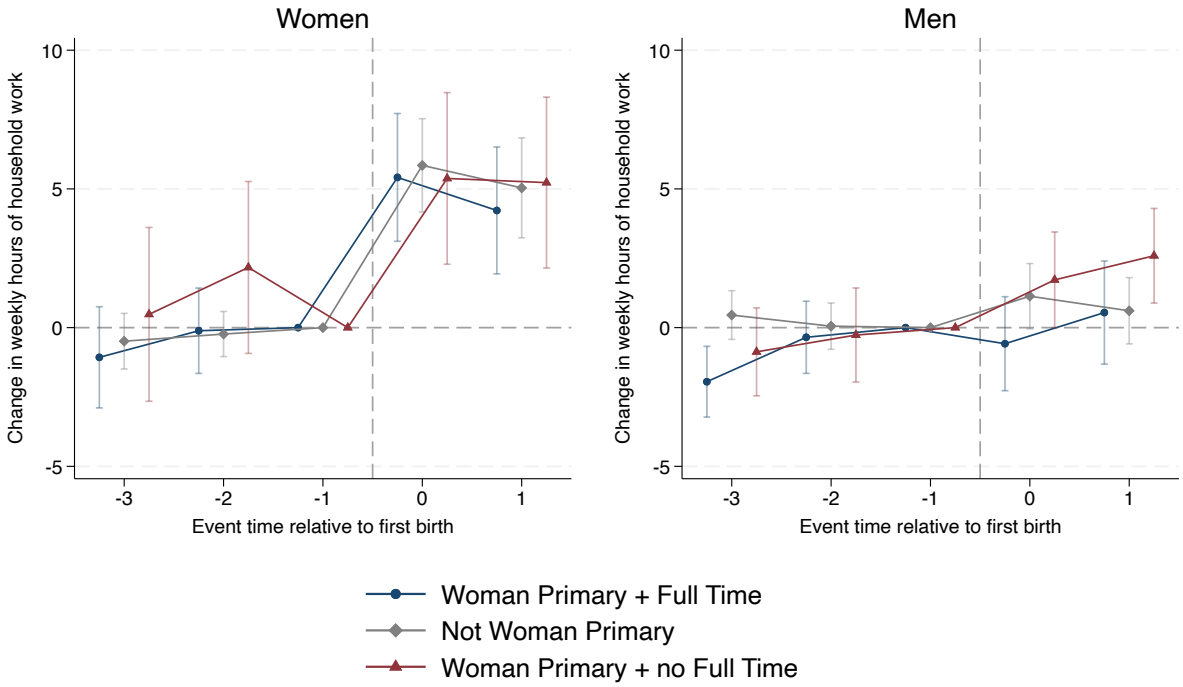
Notes: Figure shows changes in hours of housework over time for women and men by couple type. All regressions are at the individual level and include controls for the duration of the relationship squared, age squared, and marital status, household income, female's post-secondary education, and male's post-secondary education. Standard errors are clustered by the couple. The reference period is the year immediately preceding a birth. The pre-period includes three years before the birth, however the panel is unbalanced in period -2 and -3 before the birth, as the couple only needs to be observed once before a birth. The post period includes the year of the birth and one more year, after which couples with children are removed from the sample. Points are offset horizontally for readability.

Figure 3: Hours of Market Work Event Study, by Couple Type



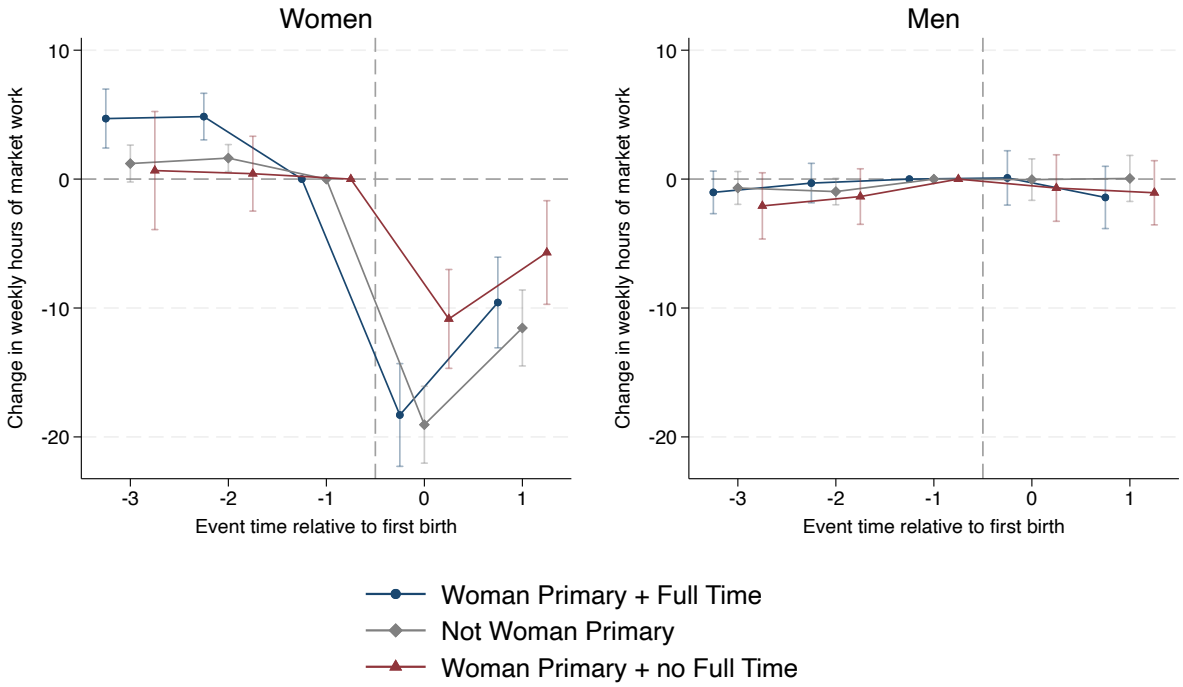
Notes: Figure shows changes in hours of paid employment over time for women and men by couple type. All regressions are at the individual level and include controls for the duration of the relationship squared, age squared, and marital status, household income, female's post-secondary education, and male's post-secondary education. Standard errors are clustered by the couple. The reference period is the year immediately preceding a birth. The pre-period includes three years before the birth, however the panel is unbalanced in period -2 and -3 before the birth, as the couple only needs to be observed once before a birth. The post period includes the year of the birth and one more year, after which couples with children are removed from the sample. Points are offset horizontally for readability.

Figure 4: Hours of Household Work Event Study, considering Women's Labor Supply



Notes: Figure shows changes in hours of housework over time for women and men by couple type. All regressions are at the individual level and include controls for the duration of the relationship squared, age squared, and marital status, household income, female's post-secondary education, and male's post-secondary education. Standard errors are clustered by the couple. The reference period is the year immediately preceding a birth. The pre-period includes three years before the birth, however the panel is unbalanced in period -2 and -3 before the birth, as the couple only needs to be observed once before a birth. The post period includes the year of the birth and one more year, after which couples with children are removed from the sample. Points are offset horizontally for readability.

Figure 5: Hours of Market Work Event Study, considering Women's Labor Supply



Notes: Figure shows changes in hours of paid employment over time for women and men by couple type. All regressions are at the individual level and include controls for the duration of the relationship squared, age squared, and marital status, household income, female's post-secondary education, and male's post-secondary education. Standard errors are clustered by the couple. The reference period is the year immediately preceding a birth. The pre-period includes three years before the birth, however the panel is unbalanced in period -2 and -3 before the birth, as the couple only needs to be observed once before a birth. The post period includes the year of the birth and one more year, after which couples with children are removed from the sample. Points are offset horizontally for readability.

Table 1: Balance Table of Baseline Characteristics by Couple Type Assignment

				p-value	
	Woman Primary	Equal	Man Primary	WP=Equal	WP=MP
Couples					
Legally Married	0.259	0.227	0.163	0.149	<0.001
Current Relationship Duration	1.720	1.431	1.444	0.015	0.052
Has a child during sample	0.461	0.503	0.422	0.103	0.189
Man has non-resident children	0.087	0.071	0.082	0.270	0.754
Household Income	102,937	112,245	110,403	0.003	0.038
Men					
Household Errands Hours/Week	1.861	3.125	4.665	<0.001	<0.001
Housework Hours/Week	3.107	5.650	8.457	<0.001	<0.001
Outdoor Housework Hours/Week	1.600	2.898	4.496	<0.001	<0.001
Employed Full time	0.838	0.827	0.773	0.568	0.005
Employed Part time	0.104	0.111	0.129	0.664	0.186
Not Employed	0.058	0.062	0.096	0.741	0.014
Individual Income	59,003	61,359	61,163	0.264	0.388
Age	28.2	28.2	28.6	0.920	0.393
Post-Secondary Education	0.664	0.678	0.661	0.583	0.912
Indigenous	0.026	0.024	0.035	0.878	0.407
Immigrant	0.166	0.158	0.171	0.666	0.821
Number of Non-resident Children	0.155	0.117	0.153	0.168	0.953
Women					
Household Errands Hours/Week	4.936	3.071	1.927	<0.001	<0.001
Housework Hours/Week	12.398	7.406	4.255	<0.001	<0.001
Outdoor Housework Hours/Week	2.248	1.266	0.604	<0.001	<0.001
Employed Full time	0.590	0.707	0.731	<0.001	<0.001
Employed Part time	0.242	0.211	0.192	0.162	0.041
Not Employed	0.166	0.082	0.078	<0.001	<0.001
Individual Income	41,477	48,032	46,867	<0.001	0.003
Age	26.3	26.2	26.0	0.666	0.365
Post-Secondary Education	0.687	0.721	0.665	0.152	0.429
Indigenous	0.033	0.028	0.028	0.593	0.681
Immigrant	0.179	0.172	0.137	0.713	0.050
Observations	703	785	490		

Note: Means of characteristics of couples, men, and women by couple type are reported in columns one through three. The means are based on the first observation of the couple. Couple type assignment is defined by share of hours of household work done by each individual in the couple in the first observation in the data. Column four provides p-values from the test for the mean for the woman primary couples is equal to the mean of the equal share couples. Similarly column five gives the p-value from the test for the mean for the woman primary couples is equal to the mean of man primary couples. Incomes are measured in AUD and are nominal values from the year of the survey. The number of children for men comes from their non-resident children.

Table 2: Gender Attitudes by Couple Type Assignment

	WP	Equal	MP
Men			
It is better if the man works and the woman takes care of the home and children.	3.186	2.883	2.594
Kids do just as well if the mom earns money and the dad cares for the home/kids.	5.274	5.599	5.597
Mothers who don't really need to work shouldn't.	3.350	2.872	3.062
If both partners work, they should share the housework and childcare equally.	5.898	5.778	5.822
It is not good for a relationship if the women earns more than the man.	2.248	2.179	2.039
On the whole, men make better political leaders than women do.	3.062	2.876	2.625
Women			
It is better if the man works and the woman takes care of the home and children.	2.781	2.386	2.372
Kids do just as well if the mom earns money and the dad cares for the home/kids.	5.684	5.762	6.039
Mothers who don't really need to work shouldn't.	2.864	2.446	2.667
If both partners work, they should share the housework and childcare equally.	6.219	6.192	6.271
It is not good for a relationship if the women earns more than the man.	1.974	1.888	1.899
On the whole, men make better political leaders than women do.	2.285	1.996	2.070

Note: Means of responses to the statements listed by couple type. The responses are on a scale from 1 to 7, where 1 strongly disagrees and 7 strongly agrees. This set of questions is not included in the survey every year. The responses included in the averages shown are from individuals in the sample who were asked this set of questions in the first wave in which they are observed.

Table 3: Baseline Outcomes by Couple Type Assignment

				p-value	
	WP	Equal	MP	WP=Equal	WP=MP
Men					
Hrs/Week on Household Tasks	6.568	11.673	17.618	<0.001	<0.001
Hrs/Week Paid Employment	39.678	39.605	37.608	0.924	0.020
"I do more than my fair share of housework."	2.728	2.983	3.212	<0.001	<0.001
Relationship Satisfaction	0.445	0.449	0.412	0.875	0.261
Happy	0.645	0.662	0.641	0.499	0.872
Women					
Hrs/Week on Household Tasks	19.582	11.744	6.786	<0.001	<0.001
Hrs/Week Paid Employment	29.543	34.423	34.636	<0.001	<0.001
"I do more than my fair share of housework."	3.867	3.568	3.320	<0.001	<0.001
Relationship Satisfaction	0.429	0.437	0.415	0.763	0.635
Happy	0.624	0.621	0.603	0.923	0.464
Observations	703	785	490		

Note: Means for the outcome variables are reported based on the first observations of the couples, capturing the outcomes before any couples are treated. The outcome "I do more than my fair share of the housework" is on a scale from 1 to 5, where 1 indicates doing much less than their fair share and 5 indicates doing much more than their fair share. Relationship satisfaction and happy are binary variables indicating if the individual responded that they were satisfied with their relationship or were happy in general. Mean outcomes are provided for couples categorized by woman primary, equal, or man primary based on share of household work done by each individual in the couple. The final two columns give p-values from the test if woman primary couples' outcomes are equal to the outcomes from the other couple types.

Table 4: Change in time use after a child, by couple type

Panel i. Hours of Household Work	Couple	Women	Men	P-value: Women = Men
Woman Primary*Birth	8.772***	6.782***	2.083***	0.2080
	(1.408)	(1.115)	(0.765)	
Equal*Birth	9.479***	8.390***	1.267	0.0042
	(1.317)	(1.023)	(0.785)	
Man Primary*Birth	9.464***	8.812***	0.613	0.0014
	(1.537)	(1.177)	(0.952)	
P-values:				
WP = Equal	0.4648	0.0452	0.0994	
WP = MP	0.5683	0.0352	0.0489	
Equal = MP	0.9893	0.6336	0.3576	
Observations	9754	10046	9827	

Panel ii. Hours of Paid Employment	Couple	Women	Men	Women = Men
Woman Primary*Birth	-13.327***	-15.947***	0.873	0.0000
	(2.774)	(2.124)	(1.227)	
Equal*Birth	-15.332***	-17.796***	1.331	0.0000
	(2.784)	(2.061)	(1.263)	
Man Primary*Birth	-15.129***	-17.687***	1.425	0.0000
	(2.936)	(2.369)	(1.323)	
P-values:				
WP = Equal	0.2152	0.1251	0.5441	
WP = MP	0.3432	0.2358	0.5709	
Equal = MP	0.9160	0.9376	0.9210	
Observations	10967	10122	9919	

Notes: *** p<.01, ** p<.05, * p<.1 Coefficient estimates are reported with standard errors in parenthesis. The regression in column 1 is run at the couple level and includes couple and wave fixed effects and a control for the duration of the relationship squared. All other regressions are at the individual level and include individual, couple, and wave fixed effects and controls for the duration of the relationship squared, age squared, and marital status, household income, female's post-secondary education, and male's post-secondary education interacted with birth. Standard errors are clustered by the couple. Column 1 estimates the coefficients for the couple, column 2 for the female partners, column 3 for the men. Below the results are p-values comparing pairwise results and column 4 has p-values comparing women's and men's estimates. The outcome in panel i is the number of total hours of household work per week for the couple in column 1 and the individuals in columns 2-4. Household work does not include childcare tasks. The outcome in panel ii is the number of hours of paid employment per week for the individual.

Table 5: Hours of childcare, by couple type

	Couple	Women	Men	P-value: Women = Men
Woman Primary*Birth	54.726***	47.229***	14.328***	0.0000
	(3.079)	(2.615)	(1.418)	
Equal*Birth	53.646***	47.478***	15.289***	0.0000
	(3.159)	(2.622)	(1.495)	
Man Primary*Birth	51.929***	45.349***	14.156***	0.0001
	(3.416)	(2.843)	(1.620)	
P-values:				
WP = Equal	0.6082	0.8847	0.3097	
WP = MP	0.2784	0.3677	0.8862	
Equal = MP	0.4872	0.2788	0.2992	
Observations	5984	5176	4978	

Notes: *** p<.01, ** p<.05, * p<.1 Coefficient estimates are reported with standard errors in parenthesis. The regression in column 1 is run at the couple level and includes couple and wave fixed effects and a control for the duration of the relationship squared. All other regressions are at the individual level and include individual, couple, and wave fixed effects and controls for the duration of the relationship squared, age squared, and marital status, household income, female's post-secondary education, and male's post-secondary education interacted with birth. Standard errors are clustered by the couple. Column 1 estimates the coefficients for the couple, column 2 for the female partners, column 3 for the men. Below the results are p-values comparing pairwise results and column 4 has p-values comparing women's and men's estimates. The outcome is the number of hours of childcare per week.

Table 6: Change in doing "more than fair share" after a child, by couple type

	Women	Men	P-value: Women = Men
Woman Primary*Birth	0.271***	0.089	0.6319
	(0.068)	(0.069)	
Equal*Birth	0.357***	-0.018	0.0370
	(0.070)	(0.067)	
Man Primary*Birth	0.515***	-0.138**	0.0000
	(0.077)	(0.070)	
P-values:			
WP = Equal	0.0785	0.0174	
WP = MP	0.0001	0.0000	
Equal = MP	0.0073	0.0186	
Observations	10227	9953	

Notes: *** p<.01, ** p<.05, * p<.1 Coefficient estimates are reported with standard errors in parenthesis. All regressions are at the individual level and include individual, couple, and wave fixed effects and controls for the duration of the relationship and age squared, as well as marital status, household income, female's post-secondary education and male's post-secondary education interacted with birth. Standard errors are clustered by the couple. Column 1 gives the coefficients for the female partners and column 2 for the men. Below the results are p-values comparing pairwise results and column 3 has p-values comparing women's and men's estimates. The outcome is the individual's response to "I do more than my fair share of the housework" on a scale from 1 to 5, where 1 indicates feeling that they are doing much less than their fair share and 5 indicates feeling that they do much more than their fair share.

Table 7: Change in relationship satisfaction and happiness after a child, by couple type

Panel i. Relationship Satisfaction	Women	Men	P-value: Women = Men
Woman Primary*Birth	-0.087**	-0.025	0.6643
	(0.037)	(0.039)	
Equal*Birth	-0.131***	-0.030	0.4519
	(0.038)	(0.042)	
Man Primary*Birth	-0.067*	-0.067*	0.4855
	(0.041)	(0.041)	
P-values:			
WP = Equal	0.1010	0.8460	
WP = MP	0.5429	0.1907	
Equal = MP	0.0430	0.2557	
Observations	10229	9942	
Panel ii. Happiness	Women	Men	P-value: Women = Men
Woman Primary*Birth	0.043	-0.022	0.3803
	(0.038)	(0.041)	
Equal*Birth	0.092**	-0.034	0.1000
	(0.039)	(0.040)	
Man Primary*Birth	0.084*	-0.069	0.0363
	(0.044)	(0.042)	
P-values:			
WP = Equal	0.0908	0.6910	
WP = MP	0.2685	0.1905	
Equal = MP	0.0400	0.3144	
Observations	10234	9972	

Notes: *** p<.01, ** p<.05, * p<.1 Coefficient estimates for the effect of having a child and couple type on measures of well-being are reported with standard errors in parenthesis. All regressions are at the individual level and include individual, couple, and wave fixed effects and controls for the duration of the relationship and age squared, as well as marital status, household income, female's post-secondary education and male's post-secondary education interacted with birth. Standard errors are clustered by the couple. Column 1 gives the coefficients for the female partners and column 2 for the men. Below the results are p-values comparing pairwise results and column 3 has p-values comparing women's and men's estimates. The outcome in panel i is a binary variable for the individual feeling satisfied with the relationship with their partner. The outcome in panel ii is binary variable for the individual being overall happy.

Table 8: Change in time use after a child, considering women's labor supply

Panel i. Hours of Household Work	Couple	Women	Men	P-value: Women = Men
Woman Primary + Full Time*Birth	8.813***	7.795***	1.341	0.0242
	(1.526)	(1.170)	(0.868)	
Woman Primary + no FT*Birth	8.707***	5.289***	3.069***	0.7493
	(1.772)	(1.451)	(0.928)	
non-Woman Primary*Birth	9.484***	8.790***	0.822	0.0004
	(1.296)	(0.985)	(0.801)	
P-values:				
WP+FT = nonWP	0.5132	0.2400	0.3200	
WP+FT = WP+noFT	0.9491	0.0626	0.0648	
WP+noFT = nonWP	0.6009	0.0038	0.0102	
Observations	9754	10046	9827	

Panel ii. Hours of Paid Employment	Couple	Women	Men	Women = Men
Woman Primary + Full Time*Birth	-18.982***	-20.035***	0.660	0.0000
	(2.939)	(2.288)	(1.354)	
Woman Primary + no FT*Birth	-5.643*	-9.734***	1.213	0.0013
	(2.993)	(2.265)	(1.341)	
non-Woman Primary*Birth	-16.744***	-18.696***	1.315	0.0000
	(2.679)	(2.075)	(1.212)	
P-values:				
WP+FT = nonWP	0.1474	0.2670	0.4205	
WP+FT = WP+noFT	0.0000	0.0000	0.6357	
WP+noFT = nonWP	0.0000	0.0000	0.9217	
Observations	10967	10122	9919	

Notes: *** p<.01, ** p<.05, * p<.1 Coefficient estimates are reported with standard errors in parenthesis. Standard errors are clustered by the couple. This table divides couples by their share of household work and the woman's labor supply. WP+FT identifies couples as woman primarily doing the housework and she works full time, WP+noFT means that the couple is woman primary and the female partner does not work full time, and nonWP means that the couples is either identified as equal or man primary. The regression in column 1 is run at the couple level and includes couple and wave fixed effects and a control for the duration of the relationship squared. All other regressions are at the individual level and include individual, couple, and wave fixed effects and controls for the duration of the relationship squared, age squared, and marital status, household income, female's post-secondary education, and male's post-secondary education interacted with birth. Column 1 estimates the coefficients for the couple, column 2 for the female partners, column 3 for the men. Below the results are p-values comparing pairwise results and column 4 has p-values comparing women's and men's estimates. The outcome in panel i is the number of total hours of household work per week for the couple in column 1 and the individuals in columns 2-4. Household work does not include childcare tasks. The outcome in panel ii is the number of hours of paid employment per week for the individual.

Table 9: Hours of childcare, considering women's labor supply

	Couple	Women	Men	P-value: Women = Men
Woman Primary + Full Time*Birth	54.046***	47.088***	13.721***	0.0000
	(3.377)	(2.902)	(1.535)	
Woman Primary + no Full Time*Birth	55.382***	47.199***	14.985***	0.0002
	(3.757)	(3.057)	(1.746)	
non-Woman Primary*Birth	52.814***	46.638***	14.685***	0.0000
	(3.074)	(2.575)	(1.467)	
P-values:				
WP+FT = nonWP	0.5749	0.8077	0.3320	
WP+FT = WP+noFT	0.7051	0.9685	0.4334	
WP+noFT = nonWP	0.4245	0.8205	0.8399	
Observations	5984	5176	4978	

Notes: *** p<.01, ** p<.05, * p<.1 Coefficient estimates are reported with standard errors in parenthesis. Standard errors are clustered by the couple. This table divides couples by their share of household work and the woman's labor supply. WP+FT identifies couples as woman primarily doing the housework and she works full time, WP+noFT means that the couple is woman primary and the female partner does not work full time, and nonWP means that the couples is either identified as equal or man primary. The regression in column 1 is run at the couple level and includes couple and wave fixed effects and a control for the duration of the relationship squared. All other regressions are at the individual level and include individual, couple, and wave fixed effects and controls for the duration of the relationship squared, age squared, and marital status, household income, female's post-secondary education, and male's post-secondary education interacted with birth. Column 1 estimates the coefficients for the couple, column 2 for the female partners, column 3 for the men. Below the results are p-values comparing pairwise results and column 4 has p-values comparing women's and men's estimates. The outcome is the number of hours of childcare per week.

Table 10: Change in doing "more than fair share" after a child, considering women's labor supply

	Women	Men	P-value: Women = Men
Woman Primary + Full Time*Birth	0.312***	0.045	0.3177
	(0.074)	(0.079)	
Woman Primary + no FT*Birth	0.232***	0.133*	0.8749
	(0.084)	(0.077)	
non-Woman Primary*Birth	0.428***	-0.076	0.0014
	(0.068)	(0.065)	
P-values:			
WP+FT = nonWP	0.0197	0.0132	
WP+FT = WP+noFT	0.3167	0.2418	
WP+noFT = nonWP	0.0086	0.0015	
Observations	10227	9953	

Notes: *** p<.01, ** p<.05, * p<.1 Coefficient estimates are reported with standard errors in parenthesis. Standard errors are clustered by the couple. This table divides couples by their share of household work and the woman's labor supply. WP+FT identifies couples as woman primarily doing the housework and she works full time, WP+noFT means that the couple is woman primary and the female partner does not work full time, and nonWP means that the couples is either identified as equal or man primary. All regressions are at the individual level and include individual, couple, and wave fixed effects and controls for the duration of the relationship and age squared, as well as marital status, household income, female's post-secondary education and male's post-secondary education interacted with birth. Column 1 gives the coefficients for the female partners and column 2 for the men. Below the results are p-values comparing pairwise results and column 3 has p-values comparing women's and men's estimates. The outcome is the individual's response to "I do more than my fair share of the housework" on a scale from 1 to 5, where 1 indicates feeling that they are doing much less than their fair share and 5 indicates feeling that they do much more than their fair share.

Table 11: Change in time use after a child, considering consistent couple type assignment

Panel i. Hours of Household Work	Couple	Women	Men	P-value: Women = Men
Consistently WP*Birth	9.844***	7.158***	2.650***	0.4240
	(1.602)	(1.264)	(0.864)	
Consistently non-WP*Birth	9.993***	9.103***	0.972	0.0030
	(1.574)	(1.216)	(0.963)	
Changing*Birth	10.334***	8.623***	1.666*	0.0162
	(1.414)	(1.081)	(0.861)	
P-values:				
ConsWP = Changing	0.7037	0.1646	0.1398	
ConsWP = Cons non-WP	0.9115	0.0782	0.0271	
Cons non-WP = Changing	0.7428	0.5609	0.2632	
Observations	8917	8995	8852	
Panel ii. Hours of Paid Employment	Couple	Women	Men	Women = Men
Consistently WP*Birth	-15.569***	-15.657***	-0.264	0.0001
	(3.120)	(2.410)	(1.428)	
Consistently non-WP*Birth	-17.541***	-18.224***	0.763	0.0000
	(3.272)	(2.606)	(1.414)	
Changing*Birth	-16.179***	-18.979***	2.026	0.0000
	(2.924)	(2.188)	(1.333)	
P-values:				
ConsWP = Changing	0.7548	0.0239	0.0220	
ConsWP = Cons non-WP	0.3408	0.1202	0.3437	
Cons non-WP = Changing	0.4568	0.5813	0.1402	
Observations	9547	9022	8900	

Notes: *** p<.01, ** p<.05, * p<.1 Coefficient estimates are reported with standard errors in parenthesis. Standard errors are clustered by the couple. This table divides couples by their share of household work as observed over two waves. ConsWP identifies couples that were observed to be consistently woman primary in housework for two waves, Cons non-WP means that the couple was observed to be consistently not woman primary in housework for two waves, and changing means that the couples had two different couple type assignments over the first two waves they were observed. The regression in column 1 is run at the couple level and includes couple and wave fixed effects and a control for the duration of the relationship squared. All other regressions are at the individual level and include individual, couple, and wave fixed effects and controls for the duration of the relationship squared, age squared, and marital status, household income, female's post-secondary education, and male's post-secondary education interacted with birth. Column 1 estimates the coefficients for the couple, column 2 for the female partners, column 3 for the men. Below the results are p-values comparing pairwise results and column 4 has p-values comparing women's and men's estimates. The outcome in panel i is the number of total hours of household work per week for the couple in column 1 and the individuals in columns 2-4. Household work does not include childcare tasks. The outcome in panel ii is the number of hours of paid employment per week for the individual.

Table 12: Hours of childcare, considering consistent couple type assignment

	Couple	Women	Men	P-value: Women = Men
Consistently WP*Birth	54.803***	46.481***	14.538***	0.0001
	(3.477)	(2.988)	(1.610)	
Consistently non-WP*Birth	55.752***	47.879***	15.681***	0.0001
	(3.459)	(2.989)	(1.412)	
Changing*Birth	56.526***	48.842***	14.850***	0.0000
	(3.386)	(2.943)	(1.505)	
P-values:				
ConsWP = Changing	0.5200	0.2796	0.8169	
ConsWP = Cons non-WP	0.7415	0.5480	0.4217	
Cons non-WP = Changing	0.7348	0.6013	0.3719	
Observations	5064	4510	4345	

Notes: *** p<.01, ** p<.05, * p<.1 Coefficient estimates are reported with standard errors in parenthesis. Standard errors are clustered by the couple. This table divides couples by their share of household work as observed over two waves. ConsWP identifies couples that were observed to be consistently woman primary in housework for two waves, Cons non-WP means that the couple was observed to be consistently not woman primary in housework for two waves, and changing means that the couples had two different couple type assignments over the first two waves they were observed. The regression in column 1 is run at the couple level and includes couple and wave fixed effects and a control for the duration of the relationship squared. All other regressions are at the individual level and include individual, couple, and wave fixed effects and controls for the duration of the relationship squared, age squared, and marital status, household income, female's post-secondary education, and male's post-secondary education interacted with birth. Column 1 estimates the coefficients for the couple, column 2 for the female partners, column 3 for the men. Below the results are p-values comparing pairwise results and column 4 has p-values comparing women's and men's estimates. The outcome is the number of hours of childcare per week.

A Appendix

Table A.1: Selected Baseline Characteristics by Couple Type Assignment, Considering Women's Labor Supply

	WP + FT	WP + no FT	not WP	p-value WP+FT = WP+noFT
Couples				
Household Income	115,221	85,238	111,537	<0.001
Men				
Total Hours/Week on Household Tasks	6.50	6.66	13.96	0.665
Market work Hours/Week	41.76	36.68	38.84	<0.001
Individual Income	61,364	55,601	61,283	0.052
Post-Secondary Education	0.70	0.62	0.67	0.020
"I do more than my fair share of the housework."	2.71	2.76	3.07	0.416
Women				
Total Hours/Week on Household Tasks	17.76	22.21	9.84	<0.001
Market work Hours/Week	40.18	14.10	34.51	<0.001
Individual Income	51,253	27,389	47,515	<0.001
Post-Secondary Education	0.75	0.59	0.70	<0.001
"I do more than my fair share of the housework."	3.92	3.79	3.47	0.054
Observations	438	332	1,392	

Notes: Means of characteristics of couples, men, and women by couple type considering women's labor supply are reported in columns one through three. The means are based on the first observation of the couple. Couple type assignment is defined by share of hours of household work done by each individual in the couple and the women's labor supply in the first observation in the data. Column 1 provides means for couples in which women do the majority of the household labor and work full time outside of the home. Column 2 provides means for couples in which the women to the majority of the household labor and do not work full time outside of the home. Column 3 provides means for couples in which the household labor is either shared equally or men do more of it. Column 4 gives p-values from the test for the mean for the woman primary couples where the woman works full time is equal to the mean for the woman primary couples where the woman does not work full time.

Table A.2: Selected Baseline Characteristics by Couple Type Assignment, Considering Consistent Couple Type Assignment

	Cons. WP	Cons. non-WP	Changing	p-value Cons. WP = Cons. non-WP
Couples				
Household Income	101,627	115,636	107,149	0.001
Men				
Total Hours/Week on Household Tasks	6.574	14.191	11.390	<0.001
Market work Hours/Week	39.542	38.548	38.941	0.361
Individual Income	58,559	62,164	59,807	0.203
Post-Secondary Education	0.643	0.675	0.683	0.341
"I do more than my fair share of the housework."	2.608	3.124	3.007	<0.001
Women				
Total Hours/Week on Household Tasks	21.101	9.406	12.355	<0.001
Market work Hours/Week	29.128	35.762	32.364	<0.001
Individual Income	40,127	51,052	44,812	<0.001
Post-Secondary Education	0.688	0.718	0.704	0.343
"I do more than my fair share of the housework."	3.949	3.381	3.559	<0.001
Observations	336	507	829	

Notes: Means of characteristics of couples, men, and women by couple type. Couple type assignment is defined by share of hours of household work done by each individual in the couple and in the first and second observation of the couple in the data. Column 1 provides means for couples where the female partner consistently does more of the household labor over the first two waves in which they are observed. Column 2 provides means for couples where the female partner consistently does not do more of the household labor over the first two waves in which they are observed. Column 3 provides means for couples whose couple type varies between the first two waves in which they are observed. Column 4 gives p-values from the test for the mean for the consistently woman primary couples is equal to the mean for the consistently not woman primary couples.